Published by a fencing parent and his bot.

The EN GARDE ELITE FC GAZETTE

THE ELITE FENCERS CLUB WEEKLY

It is better to deserve a rating than to have one.

WEDNESDAY EDITION

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First Bouts at Medeo #5

Seven Elite FC fencers, most in their first tournament, stepped on the strip at Medeo Youth Challenge #5.

Seven Elite FC fencers took a first competitive step on Sunday at Medeo Youth Challenge #5, at Medeo Fencing Club in Bound Brook.

Samuel SarroWaite fenced in Y12 Mixed. Roy Yoo, Elle Peterfreund, Nora Li and Claire Widjaja fenced in Y10 Mixed. Owen Li and Mira Shukla fenced in Y14 Mixed.

For most, it was their first tournament. Elle Peterfreund and Owen Li were fencing their second.

Showing up for those first bouts is how a competitive path starts. You pack the bag, you check in, and you fence. Ratings and bigger events come later. Sunday was the beginning.

OVERHEARD ON REDDIT

Do You Need Fencing Shoes?

A beginner asked r/Fencing whether tennis shoes work as well as fencing shoes, at about half the price. r/Fencing commenters said the usual recommendation is indoor court shoes — squash or volleyball, a common example being ASICS Gel Rocket — and that entry fencing shoes, at about $80 to $100, wear out in a year or two. Some epee fencers prefer tennis shoes on aluminum strips. That's the commenters' opinion, not advice.

DEADLINES

DATE	WHAT CLOSES
Nov. 11	Junior Olympics — regular-fee deadline
Jan. 8	N.J. high school — independent fencers' entries close

USA Fencing deadlines are 11:59 p.m. Pacific (2:59 a.m. Eastern the next day). The Junior Olympics regular-fee deadline is today.

EPEE ON SCREEN

DATES	EVENT
Nov. 11	Youth Olympic Games, men's epee (Dakar)
Nov. 12–15	Senior World Cups: Berne (men), Wuxi (women) — FencingTV
Nov. 26–29	Junior/Cadet World Cup (Novi Sad, Serbia)
Dec. 3–6	Senior World Cup, men and women (Vancouver) — FencingTV

Dakar streams from the FIE; Berne, Wuxi and Vancouver are on FencingTV. No start times listed. No stream listed for Novi Sad.

CLUB RESULTS

FENCER	EVENT	FINISH
Maksim Milinkovic	Senior Open, Mixed (Nov. 8)	7th of 31
Nico Ng	Senior Open, Mixed (Nov. 8)	8th of 31
Madeline Siu	NYFA #1, Y8 Mixed (Nov. 8)	3rd of 4
Maximus Siu	NYFA #1, Y10 Mixed (Nov. 8)	8th of 17
Remy Ng	NYFA #1, Y12 Men (Nov. 8)	8th of 13
Christina Jiang	NYFA #1, Y12 Women (Nov. 8)	5th of 9
Mila Siu	NYFA #1, Y14 Women (Nov. 8)	5th of 10
Stella Kuo	NYFA #1, Y14 Women (Nov. 8)	6th of 10

Elite FC was well represented last weekend. We hope to see more and more of the club's kids at events.



Maximus Siu, 8th of 17 in Y10, is among the finalists pictured at NYFA Youth Cup #1.

ON THE ROAD — ELITE FC ENTRIES

KIEFER MEINHARDT CUP · Glen Allen, Va. · Nov. 14–15

EVENT	ELITE FC
SATURDAY, NOV. 14	
Y14 Women	Stella Kuo, Mila Siu
SUNDAY, NOV. 15	
Y12 Women	Stella Kuo, Mila Siu

NOVEMBER NAC · Columbus, Ohio · Nov. 20–23

EVENT	ELITE FC
FRIDAY, NOV. 20	
Junior Women	Anayaa Sheth
SATURDAY, NOV. 21	
Cadet Men	Nico Ng
SUNDAY, NOV. 22	
Junior Men	Athreya Aravind, Nico Ng

NEARBY TOURNAMENTS — ELITE FC ENTRIES

PIZZA RYC/RJCC · New Haven, Conn. · Nov. 14–15

TIME	EVENT	ELITE FC
SATURDAY, NOV. 14		
8:00 AM	Y14 Women	Penny Young
1:00 PM	Junior Women	Amina Gore
SUNDAY, NOV. 15		
8:00 AM	Cadet Women	Amina Gore, Penny Young
12:00 PM	Y12 Women	Penny Young

COBRA CHALLENGE SYC/RCC · Secaucus, N.J. · Nov. 27–29

EVENT	ELITE FC
FRIDAY, NOV. 27	
Y14 Men	Connor Anderson, Noah Gore, Kian Jaising, Remy Ng, Ash Shah-Mirani
Cadet Women	Amina Gore, Olivia Hayes, Stella Kuo, Lillian Liu, Mila Siu, Penny Young
Y10 Men	Bryce Cheng, Joshua Jeong
SATURDAY, NOV. 28	
Y12 Women	Christina Jiang, Stella Kuo, Mila Siu, Penny Young
Y12 Men	Kian Jaising, Joshua Jeong, Remy Ng
SUNDAY, NOV. 29	
Y14 Women	Stella Kuo, Mila Siu, Penny Young
Cadet Men	Connor Anderson, Nico Ng, Caden Wu

Pizza is at the Floyd Little Athletic Center. Cobra is at the Meadowlands Expo Center. Entry lists last confirmed Nov. 9–10; Cobra lists no start times.

Also on the calendar. This weekend, three local events have no Elite FC entries yet. On Saturday, Nov. 14, Revolution Fencing Center hosts Y10, Y12 and Y14 Mixed in West Chester, Pa.; preregistration closes that day. On Sunday, Nov. 15, Freehold Fencing's November Open (Senior Men and Women, in Freehold, N.J.) and Wanglei Fencing's November Cup II (Cadet and Junior, in Plainsboro Township, N.J.) are good practice with decently competitive fields, a fit for older fencers. Preregistration for both Sunday events closes Saturday, Nov. 14.

FOR THE PARENTS
What a Rating Letter Means

A rating is a letter. USA Fencing classifies fencers A (the highest), then B, C, D, E, and U — unclassified, where everyone starts. The letter is followed by a year: A26 means an A earned or re-earned in 2026. A rating is official only on USA Fencing's membership list. It lasts four seasons; if it isn't renewed, it drops one letter at the start of the next season, on Aug. 1 — a B earned in 2020 (B20) became a C24 on Aug. 1, 2024.

Ratings are earned, one weapon at a time, at sanctioned competitions from local events to national ones. A competition's classification — Group E1, D1, C1 and so on — depends on the size of the field and the ratings already in it, and that determines what can be awarded. Group E1, the smallest that awards a rating, needs at least six fencers, none of whom have to be rated already. First place earns an E. Larger groups can award higher letters, and E's further down the results. The official chart is in the Athlete Handbook (2026–27).

Ratings also seed the field, ordering fencers from strongest to weakest at the start of a competition. At local youth events, seeding is by rating and the year it was last earned. At many regional and national events, national points come first, then rating and year. In many categories, fencers with the same letter and year are placed in random order. Only official membership-list ratings should be used when seeding. The letter is a seeding tool, not a verdict. Every A in the club started as a U.

FOR THE PARENTS
What "Triple Fees" Means

At USA Fencing national tournaments — NACs, the Junior Olympics, Summer Nationals — each event page posts a regular-fee deadline. Miss it, and late entries are still taken online for a set window, but they cost triple the regular total, through 5 p.m. local time the night before the event.

On the Junior Olympics and November NAC pages, one event is $225, two are $320, three are $415; after the deadline those become $675, $960 and $1,245.

The Junior Olympics regular-fee deadline is today, Wednesday, Nov. 11. The November NAC, Nov. 20–23 in Columbus, is already in its late-fee window.

Regional tournaments post their own fee schedules and late rates on each event's page. Those are not the national triple-fee rule.

